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DESIGN CODE NS 06

Momo the Loaf Cat

US crochet terms · Advanced beginner · No-sew body · 2-2.5 hours

A cat folded into a perfect loaf. Worked in one piece on an oval base so the finished shape is genuinely wider than it is tall, with the ears crocheted straight onto the head and the tail worked off the body — there are no separate pieces to sew on.

SAFETY — READ THIS FIRST

Momo has **two 8 mm safety eyes**. Safety eyes are small parts. Lock the washers firmly from the inside and pull-test each one on the finished toy — a properly locked washer will not come off by hand.

Embroidering the eyes instead is safer, but it does not make Momo a tested toy. This pattern has not been tested to a toy-safety standard such as ASTM F963 or EN 71, so please do not describe finished Momos as "baby-safe" or "suitable from birth" in your listings. For a child under three, embroidered eyes are the right choice — but say "embroidered, no small parts", not "baby-safe".

The tail and ears are worked into the body fabric rather than sewn on, which is genuinely stronger than a sewn join. Still weave every end in for at least 5 cm and bury it, and knot the embroidery floss inside the body.

MATERIALS

Main yarn — Worsted #4, about **10 g**. Grey, ginger, cream or black — all four sell equally well. One 25 g ball makes two with yarn to spare.

Contrast — Small amounts of white for the chest and paws, pink for the nose and inner ears.

Hook — 3.5 mm (US E-4). Tight gauge so stuffing cannot show through.

Eyes — 2 × 8 mm safety eyes, or embroider in black.

Also needed — Polyfill about **10 g**; tapestry needle; stitch marker; black embroidery floss.

GAUGE & FINISHED SIZE

Gauge — Worsted #4 on a 3.5 mm hook: about 4.5 mm per stitch and 4.3 mm per round.

Finished size — About **7.9 cm (3.1 in) long, 5.2 cm (2 in) wide and 4.3 cm (1.7 in) tall** — a low, wide loaf, not a ball. Width to height is about 1.2 : 1, which is what reads as a loaf.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR magic ring · **ch** chain · **sc** single crochet · **inc** 2 sc in one stitch · **dec** invisible decrease · **sl st** slip stitch · **BLO** back loop only · **FO** fasten off · **(n)** stitch count

Work in a continuous spiral — do not join between rounds. Mark the first stitch of every round.

CORE TECHNIQUES

These are the techniques Momo uses, in the order you will meet them.

1 · WORKING AROUND A CHAIN (the oval base). This is the one that makes the loaf. You crochet into **both sides** of a starting chain: work across the front of the chain, put the corner increases into the last chain, then continue back along the opposite side and finish into the last remaining loop. That turns a chain into a flat oval instead of a strip. Do not substitute a magic-ring circle here — a round base gives you a sphere

every time.

2 • THE MAGIC RING. Used for the tail's first round. Wrap the yarn once around two fingers, insert the hook, pull up a loop, work the round into the ring, then pull the tail tight.

3 • WORK IN A SPIRAL. Do not join and do not ch 1 between rounds. Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round and move it up each time — there is no join to count from.

4 • BACK LOOP ONLY (BLO). Work into the far loop of the stitch only. The unused loops form a raised ridge — that ridge is the visible edge where the base meets the walls, and it is what makes the loaf read as folded rather than moulded.

5 • THE INVISIBLE DECREASE. Insert the hook through the **front loops only** of the next two stitches, yarn over and pull through both, then yarn over and pull through the remaining two loops. Every dec here is worked this way.

6 • FLAT ROWS (ch 1, turn). The ears are not worked in the round. Chain 1, turn, and work back along the row you just made. Each row is shorter than the one before, which is what forms the ear point.

7 • WORKING INTO BODY FABRIC. The tail starts by pushing the hook through the finished body wall rather than into a stitch of the current round. Go under a whole stitch, not just one loop, or it will pull out.

1. BODY — ONE PIECE, WORKED ON AN OVAL BASE

The oval base is what makes this a loaf rather than a ball, and **the size of the base sets the size of the whole cat**. The base is worked up to 48 stitches before the walls begin; stopping at 36 gives a body about 34 mm across, which comes out taller than it is wide and reads as a ball no matter how you stuff it.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
Foundation	ch 9 sc in 2nd ch from hook, sc	chain only	
Rnd 1	in next 6, 3 sc in last ch, sc in next 6, 2 sc in last loop (18)		worked around both sides of the chain
Rnd 2	inc, 6 sc, inc x3, 6 sc, inc x2 (24)		
Rnd 3	sc, inc, 6 sc, [sc, inc] x3, 6 sc, [sc, inc] x2 (30)		
Rnd 4	2 sc, inc, 6 sc, [2 sc, inc] x3, 6 sc, [2 sc, inc] x2 (36)		
Rnd 5	3 sc, inc, 6 sc, [3 sc, inc] x3, 6 sc, [3 sc, inc] x2 (42)		
Rnd 6	4 sc, inc, 6 sc, [4 sc, inc] x3, 6 sc, [4 sc, inc] x2 (48)		base at full size
Rnd 7	BLO sc around (48)		ridge = the base edge
Rnd 8	sc in each st around (48)		eyes at Rnd 8-9
Rnd 9	sc in each st around (48)		stuff firmly from here
Rnd 10	[6 sc, dec] x6 (42)		
Rnd 11	[5 sc, dec] x6 (36)		
Rnd 12	[4 sc, dec] x6 (30)		ears worked onto Rnd 12
Rnd 13	[3 sc, dec] x6 (24)		
Rnd 14	[2 sc, dec] x6 (18)		
Rnd 15	[sc, dec] x6 (12)		top up the stuffing
Rnd 16	dec x6 (6)		

Finish. Thread the tail through the front loop of each remaining stitch, pull tight, knot and bury the end.

Shape check. The base is an oval about **79 mm long and 52 mm across**; the walls add ten rounds of height, so the finished loaf is about **43 mm tall** — wider than it is tall, which is the whole point. If yours is coming out round, either you stopped increasing at Rnd 4 instead of Rnd 6, or you worked extra plain rounds at Rnds 8-9.

2. EARS — CROCHETED DIRECTLY ONTO THE HEAD, MAKE 2

No separate pieces. Join the main yarn to the head at **Rnd 12**, leaving about 6 stitches between the two ears, and work each ear as three short rows.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
Row 1	sc in next 5	(5)	ch 1, turn
Row 2	dec, sc, dec	(3)	ch 1, turn
Row 3	dec, sc	(2)	ear tip

Finish. FO, leaving a short tail. Pull the tail through the 2 tip stitches to close the point, then bury it inside the head.

Each row consumes exactly what the row before produced: 5 stitches into Row 2 (2 + 1 + 2), then 3 stitches into Row 3 (2 + 1).

Embroider a small pink triangle on the front of each ear if you want lined ears.

3. TAIL — WORKED OFF THE BODY

Join the main yarn to the back of the body at about **Rnd 9**, on the center line.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
Rnd 1	4 sc in MR	(4)	worked into the body fabric
Rnd 2	sc in each st around	(4)	
Rnd 3	sc in each st around	(4)	
Rnd 4	sc in each st around	(4)	
Rnd 5	sc in each st around	(4)	
Rnd 6	sc in each st around	(4)	
Rnd 7	sc in each st around	(4)	
Rnd 8	sc in each st around	(4)	

Finish. FO. Do not stuff — a thin tail curls around the loaf far better than a stuffed one.

To start the tail on the body: insert the hook under a stitch, pull up a loop, and work the first 4 sc into the body fabric in a tight square. From Rnd 2 you are working in a normal spiral off those 4 stitches.

4. FACE

Eyes. Fix the 8 mm safety eyes between Rnds 8 and 9, about 7 stitches apart, low and wide on the front of the loaf. Seven stitches is about 32 mm, roughly 60% of the body width. A loaf cat's eyes sit low — high eyes make it read as a bear.

Nose. Embroider a small pink triangle centered between and just below the eyes, then two short stitches angled down from the point to make the mouth.

Whisker dots. Three tiny black French knots on each side of the nose.

Chest and paws. With white yarn, embroider a soft oval on the chest and two small ovals at the front of the base for tucked paws. This is what turns a plain loaf into a cat.

5. COLORWAYS THAT SELL

Grey tabby, orange ginger, cream, black, and calico (grey base with ginger and cream patches embroidered on afterwards). Listing all five as photographs in one listing consistently outperforms listing them separately, because buyers are choosing a cat, not a pattern.

TROUBLESHOOTING

It came out round. You stopped increasing at Rnd 4 instead of Rnd 6, worked too many plain rounds at Rnds 8-9, or used a magic-ring base instead of the oval. The base must reach 48 stitches.

It came out tall and narrow. The base did not reach 48 stitches. Count the stitches at Rnd 6 before you start the BLO round — that one number decides the whole shape.

Ears lean backwards. Join the yarn one round lower and angle the first row slightly forward.

Tail falls off. The first 4 sc must go through the body fabric, not just under one loop.

Stuffing shows. Go down to a 3.0 mm hook. Loose gauge on 3.5 mm is the usual cause.

Face looks like a bear. The eyes are too high and too close. Drop them a round and widen to 7 stitches.

THE FINISHED PROJECT

Momo sitting in a proper loaf — long, low and wide.

Before you finish. This is a no-sew pattern, so there is nothing to lay out and assemble. Instead, check three things before you close the top: the base reached 48 stitches at Rnd 6, the BLO ridge runs all the way around in one unbroken line, and the ears are level with each other and about 6 stitches apart.

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